It was the first day–night Test in the country, played with a pink ball in swinging conditions. I was first out to Trent Boult for 5, with the total on 6, having batted as if my feet were encased in cement. Aggers, in the commentary box, offered the caveat that I had been lambing a couple of weeks previously. To maintain the rural theme, Trevor Bayliss, our coach, was closer to the mark in suggesting we were 'like deer caught in headlights'.

It was horrible. A couple more bad shots, a couple of good deliveries, and we were done. It seemed that no one in the team was good enough to stand up to them. The game was pretty much over before it had begun. We could talk around the issues by suggesting it was the result of a communication breakdown, but essentially, we had given their bowlers an unnecessarily easy day.

They would have come into the match with the mindset of being prepared to endure ninety overs in the field, six and a half hours of hard work. Their main guys would have been steeling themselves to bowl twenty-five overs. That hurts, incrementally, as the day wears on. Our batsmen failed to do their basic collective job: to hang around long enough so that the opposition bowlers tire, and there is less pace on the ball. Get them into their fourth or fifth spells and take advantage.

The lower order can do a lot of damage in that situation. I loved batting with Jimmy Anderson as a night watchman, because he was so diligent in his work, and visibly determined not to let me down. He listened to every word I said, which was a novelty. I didn't bat that many times with Stuart Broad, but our partnership in the Boxing Day Test at Melbourne in 2017 was a blast.

We led by only 46, with two wickets left, when he arrived at the crease. He knew his role was to drive home our advantage by building a partnership, and he willingly wore a couple of short-pitched deliveries. My role was to keep him sane and remind him of certain realities. The problem is that whenever tail-enders play a couple of fantastic shots – in Broady's case a pull through square leg and a sumptuous back-foot drive – they think they're Don Bradman.

Our plan was to make sure our lead grew incrementally, in batches of five runs. We worked on the theory that reaching a series of small targets leads to big gains. I managed to keep him in check, focused on the job in hand, so that we put on 100 in eighteen overs before Usman Khawaja was